What Makes AI Influencers Effective? Evidence from Instagram Comments *

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Abstract

This study examines how AI influencer attributes are associated with consumer trust, engagement, influencer loyalty, and brand trust. Drawing on source credibility, Source attractiveness, and trust transfer perspective, the study analyzes 429,194 Instagram comments related to an AI influencer. A text mining approach combining VADER sentiment analysis, keyword-based construct scoring, and structural equation modeling was used to examine relationships among credibility, expertise, authenticity, attractiveness, psychological distance, homophily, anthropomorphism, content quality, transparency, trust, engagement, loyalty, and brand trust. The results suggest that transparency, anthropomorphism, and psychological distance are the strongest predictors of trust-related evaluation. Trust is positively associated with consumer engagement and influencer loyalty, which are further associated with Brand trust. However, the modest explore learn power of the model, indicating that defining should be interpreted as exploratory text-based evidence rather than causal proof. The study contributes to influencer marketing research by using large-scale social media comments to examine naturally occurring consumer responses to virtual influencers.

*Proceedings of The 2026 IFIP WG 8.4 International Symposium on E-Business Information Systems Evolution (EBISION 2026), Article No. 4, July 8–10, 2026, Seoul, South Korea.
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1 Introduction

Influencer marketing has become an important strategy for brands seeking to build meaningful relationships with consumers on social media platforms. Companies increasingly rely on influencers to promote products and services by drawing content shared on platforms such as Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, and Twitch (Cabeza-Ramirez et al., 2022; Obermayer et al., 2022). Influencers shape consumer attitude, behaviors, and precious attention, and purchase attention by using trust, social capital, and persuasive communication (Brown & Hayes, 2008). Recent advances in artificial intelligence, machine learning, and computer-generated graphics have led to the rise of AI influencers, also known as virtual influencers. These digital personas are designed to simulate human appearance, behavior, and emotional expression (Byu,n & Ahn, 2023; Seymour et al., 2018). Well-known AI influencers such as Lu do Magalu and Lil Miquela have attracted large audiences and collaborated with global brands and organizations. As these virtual agents become more realistic and socially visible, the boundary between human and non-human influencers is becoming increasingly blurred (Thomas & Fowler, 2021; Araque & Moynihan, 2021)

Despite the rapid growth of AI influencers, academic research on how consumers perceive and trust them remains limited. Prior studies have mainly examined human influencers or survey-based responses to virtual influencers (Lou & Yuan, 2019; Sokolova & Kefi, 2020). Less attention has been given to naturally occurring consumer reactions expressed in social media comments. This is important because comments can reveal how users discuss AI influencer credibility, attractiveness, authenticity, content quality, trust, engagement, loyalty, and brand-related responses in a digital environment.

To address this gap, they study analyzes consumer discussions of AI influencers using a large-scale dataset of Instagram comments. By examining naturally occurring social media interactions. The study provides insights into how users perceive AI influencer characteristics and trust-related outcomes in real digital environments.

Contribute to AI influencer marketing research by combining a large-scale social media text analysis with established marketing theories. By using sentiment analysis, keyboard-based construct scoring, and structural equation modeling, the study provides exploratory evidence on how consumers respond to AI influencers in real social media contexts.

2 Literature review

2.1 Source Credibility

Source credibility is a central concept in marketing and advertising research. It refers to how audiences evaluate a communicator's trustworthiness and competence (Andersen & Clevenger, 1963). In influencer marketing, credibility is important because consumers are more likely to accept messages from sources they perceive as reliable, knowledgeable, and sincere (Hovland et al., 1953; Ohanian, 1990).

In this study, source credibility is reflected through expertise and authenticity. Expertise refers to the extent to which an influencer is perceived as knowledgeable and capable of providing valid information. Authenticity reflects whether the influencer is perceived as sincere, consistent, and genuine. In the context of AI influencers, these dimensions are important because followers may question whether a non-human influencer can be credible or authentic. Therefore, this study proposes:

H1: Credibility of AI influencers is positively associated with trust in AI influencers
H1-1: Expertise of AI influencers is positively associated with trust in AI influencers.
H1-2: Authenticity of AI influencers is positively associated with trust in AI influencers.

2.2 Source attractiveness

Source attractiveness explains how the appeal of a communicator shapes audience responses. It includes not only physical attractiveness but also perceived similarity, familiarity, and likability (McGuire, 1968; Sternthal & Samuel, 1982). In influencer marketing, attractive and relatable influencers are more likely to capture attention and encourage favorable evaluations.

For AI influencers, attractiveness can also be understood through psychological distance, homophily, and anthropomorphism. Psychological distance reflects how close or distant users feel from the influencer. Homophily refers to perceived similarity between the influencer and followers. Anthropomorphism refers to the attribution of human-like qualities, emotions, and behaviors to non-human agents.

These attributes may help Al influencers appear more socially present and relatable.

H2: The attractiveness of AI influencers is positively associated with trust in AI influencers.

H2-1: Psychological distance is positively associated with trust in AI influencers.

H2-2: Homophily is positively associated with trust in AI influencers.

H2-3: Anthropomorphism is positively associated with trust in AI influencers.

2.3 Content quality

Content quality is an important factor in online trust formation. High-quality content is usually perceived as useful, clear, relevant, and reliable. In the context of Al influencers, content quality may help followers evaluate whether the influencer provides valuable information or meaningful interaction.

Transparency is also important because AI influencers are not human agents. Clear disclosure of an influencer's AI-driven nature can reduce uncertainty and support consumer confidence. When users understand that an influencer is AI-generated, they may evaluate the interaction. More clearly and ethically. Therefore, this study proposes:

H3: Content quality of AI influencers is positively associated with trust in AI influencers.

H3-1: Transparency of AI influencers is positively associated with trust in AI influencers.

2.4 Trust, Engagement, Influencer Loyalty, and Brand Trust

Trust is a key element in influencer-follower relationships because it reduces uncertainty and supports continued interaction (Morgan & Hunt, 1994, Mayer et al.,

1995). In Al influencer contexts, trust is especially important because users may feel uncertainty about authenticity, transparency, and human-likeness.

Consumer engagement refers to users' active interaction with influencer content, such as commenting, liking, sharing, or expressing emotional involvement.

Influencer loyalty reflects a follower's intention to maintain a relationship with the influencer over time. Brand trust refers to consumer confidence in the brand connected to the influencer. In influencer marketing, trust in the influencer may be transferred to the associated brand through engagement and loyalty. Therefore, this study proposes:

H4: Trust in AI influencers is positively associated with consumer engagement.

H5: Trust in AI influencers is positively associated with influencer loyalty.

H6: Consumer engagement is positively associated with brand trust.

H7: Influences loyalty is positively associated with Brand Trust.

2.5 Conceptual Framework

The theoretical foundation of this study is based on three key theories. First, Source Credibility Theory (Hovland et al., 1953) explains that consumers are more likely to trust credible sources. Second, the Technology Acceptance Model (Davis, 1989)

highlights the importance of content quality and transparency in technology acceptance. Third, the Commitment-Trust Theory (Morgan & Hunt, 1994) identifies trust as a key driver of engagement, loyalty, and brand trust. Based on these theories, this study proposes that Al influencer characteristics are positively associated with trust in Al influencers and related consumer outcomes.

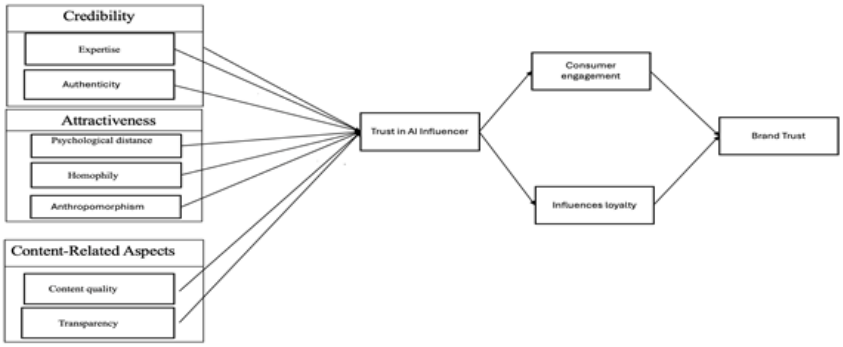


Figure1. Research model

3 Research Methods

3.1 Data Cleaning and Analytical Procedure

This study analyzed Instagram comments related to AI influencers using a quantitative big data approach. Comments were collected from the official Instagram accounts of the Al influencers included in the study during the observation period specified in Section 2024-2025. The initial dataset contained approximately 500,000 comments distributed across the selected influencers. Data preprocessing involved removing duplicate comments, URLs, hashtags, emojis, special characters, and other non-informative elements. Language detection was performed using automated filtering, and only English-language comments were retained. To reduce noise, comments identified as likely spam or bot-generated (e.g., repetitive content, excessive posting frequency, or duplicated text patterns) were excluded. After preprocessing, the final dataset consisted of 429,193 comments.

The NLP pipeline consisted of three stages. First, sentiment analysis was conducted using VADER (Valence Aware Dictionary and sentiment Reasoner), a lexicon- and rule-based model designed for social media text (Hutto & Gilbert, 2014). VADER compound sentiment scores were calculated for each comment and classified using the standard thresholds recommended by the developers: positive (-0.05), neutral (-0.05 to 0.05), and negative (< -0.05). Second, construct extraction was performed using theory-driven keyword dictionaries developed from prior literature on influencer marketing, trust, and consumer behavior. Separate dictionaries were created for credibility, expertise, authenticity, attractiveness, psychological distance, homophily, anthropomorphism, content quality, transparency, trust, engagement, loyalty, and brand trust. Construct scores were calculated based on keyword occurrence frequencies and weighted by sentiment polarity to capture both construct presence and evaluative direction. The complete keyword dictionaries and coding rules are provided in Appendix A

to support reproducibility. Third, the resulting construct-level measures were used as inputs for Structural Equation Modeling (SEM) to examine the relationships among Al influencer attributes, trust, engagement, influencer loyalty, and brand trust.

As the study is based on observational social media data, the findings indicate associations rather than causal relationships. While the preprocessing and filtering procedures were designed to reduce noise and spam, text-mining measures should be interpreted as proxies for expressed user evaluations rather than direct psychological measurements.

3.2 VADER Sentiment Analysis

To analyze the sentiment of Instagram comments, this study employed the VADER (Valence Aware Dictionary and Sentiment Reasoner) sentiment analysis tool, developed by Hutto and Gilbert (2014). Designed specifically for social media contexts, VADER is a rule-based model that combines a human-curated sentiment lexicon with a set of grammatical and syntactical heuristics.

3.3 Sentiment Analysis of Credibility, Expertise, and Authenticity - Related Comment.

Using VADER sentiment analysis (Hutto & Gilbert, 2014), comments related to credibility, expertise, and authenticity showed mixed sentiment patterns. Credibility-related comments were relatively balanced, with 31.3% positive, 36.3% neutral, and 32.4% negative sentiment, suggesting that users still evaluate an influencer's credibility cautiously. Authenticity-related comments were mostly neutral (54.2%), indicating uncertainty about whether Al influencers can be perceived as genuine. In contrast, expertise-related comments were more positive (40.2%), suggesting that users may more easily accept AI influencers as knowledgeable or competent sources. These findings are consistent with source credibility research, which argues that expertise and trustworthiness are important factors in message acceptance (Hovland et al., 1953; Ohanian, 1990). They also support prior influencer marketing studies showing that credibility-related cues play an important role in building consumer trust (Lou & Yuan, 2019).

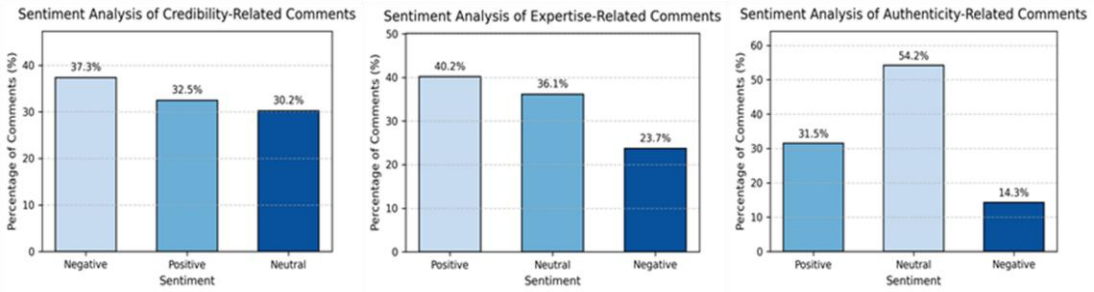


Figure 2. Sentiment Analysis of Credibility, Expertise, and Authenticity-related Comment

3.4 Sentiment Analysis of Attractiveness, Psychological-distance, Homophily, Anthropomorphism -related Comment.

Using VADER sentiment analysis (Hutto & Gilbert, 2014), comments related to attractiveness, psychological distance, homophily, and anthropomorphism were generally neutral to positive.

Attractiveness-related comments showed the highest positive sentiment (79.9%), suggesting that users often respond favorably to the visual and social appeal of Al influencers. Psychological distance was also mostly positive (59.4%), indicating that some users perceive AI influencers as socially close or relatable. Homophily-related comments were more moderately positive (46.3%), while anthropomorphism was mainly neutral (51.6%), suggesting that users may recognize human-like qualities in Al influencers but still evaluate them cautiously. These findings are consistent with source attractiveness research, which argues that attractiveness, similarity, and familiarity can strengthen persuasive communication (McGuire, 1968; Sternthal & Samuel, 1982). They also align with anthropomorphism research showing that human-like cues can support social presence and trust in non-human agents (Epley, 2018).

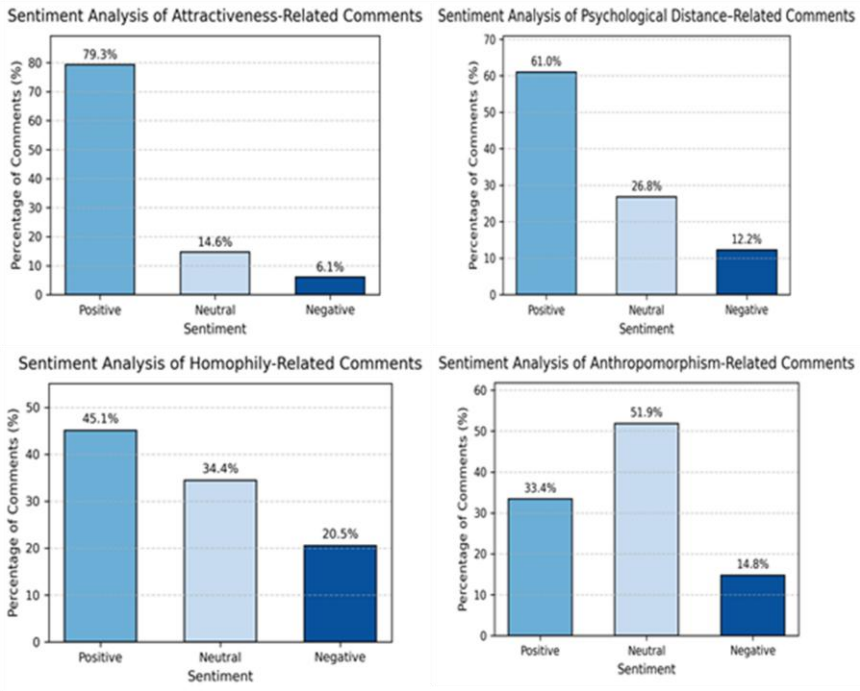


Figure 3. Sentiment Analysis of Content Quality, Transparency-related Comment

3.5 Sentiment Analysis of Content Quality, Transparency -Related Comment

Using VADER sentiment analysis (Hutto & Gilbert, 2014), content quality-related comments were mostly positive (46.1%), followed by neutral (38.5%) and negative sentiment (15.4%). This suggests that users generally respond favorably to high-quality AI influencer content, consistent with prior research on content value and consumer evaluations (Metzger & Flanagin, 2013; Lou & Yuan, 2019).

Transparency-related comments were primarily neutral (54.2%), followed by positive (30.9%) and negative sentiment (14.9%). This indicates that users discuss AI disclosure in a more informational manner, supporting previous findings that transparency helps reduce uncertainty and build trust (Boerman et al., 2017; Evans et al., 2017).

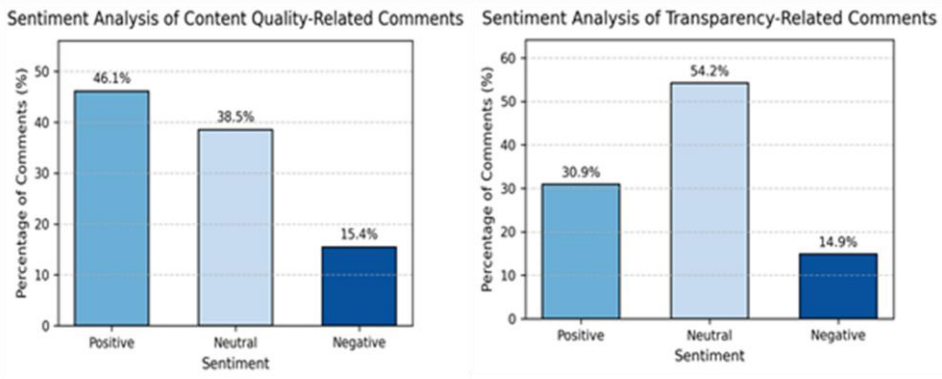


Figure 4. Sentiment Analysis of Content Quality, Transparency-related Comment

3.6 Sentiment Analysis of Influencer loyalty, Consumer Engagement, Trust, Brand trust -related Comment

The results show that consumer engagement comments were mainly positive (73.7%), followed by neutral (15.8%) and negative sentiment (10.5%). Influencer loyalty showed the strongest positive sentiment, with 81.4% positive, 14.8% neutral, and 3.8% negative comments. These findings indicate generally favorable attitudes toward AI influencers, consistent with research linking engagement and loyalty to positive user experiences (Vivek et al.,2012; Morgan & Hunt, 1994).

Brand trust comments were mostly neutral (52.3%), followed by positive (34.0%) and negative sentiment (13.7%). This suggests that while users respond positively to AI influencers, trust in associated brands remains more cautious, supporting trust transfer theory (Sichtmann, 2007).

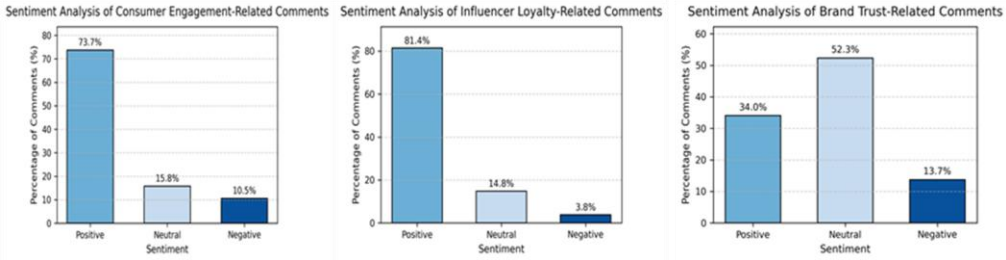


Figure5. Sentiment Analysis of Influencer Loyalty, Consumer Engagement, Trust, Brand trust - related Comment (Positive)

3.7 Structural Equation Modeling (SEM)

To examine the relationships among Al influencer attributes, trust-related evaluations, engagement, loyalty, and brand trust, this study employed Structural Equation Modeling (SEM). SEM was used as a theory-driven tool to test associations among text-derived indicators within one analytical framework (Hair et al., 2010). Because the variables were. Generated from social media comments, the results are interpreted as aggregate-level associations rather than individual psychological states or causal effects. Model fit indices were used to assess the overall plausibility of the proposed structural model (Sarstedt et al., 2020).

3.7.1 R^2 values

The R^2 results indicate the model's explanatory power for each endogenous construct. The influencer attributes explain 17.5% of the variance in trust, showing modest explanatory power. However, engagement ($R^2 = 0.048$), loyalty ($R^2 = 0.061$), and brand trust ($R^2 = 0.085$) have relatively low R' values. Such values are common in consumer behavior research, where outcomes are influenced by many individual, platform-related, and brand-related factors beyond those included in a single model (Hair et al., 2019; Falk & Miller, 1992). Therefore, the findings should be viewed as partial but meaningful evidence of trust transfer from Al influencers to brands, while recognizing that additional variables may improve the model's explanatory power (Stewart, 2003; Hair et al., 2019).

Table1. R^2 Results

Endogenous Construct	R^2
Trust	0.175
Engagement	0.048
Loyalty	0.061
Brand Trust	0.085

3.7.2 Standardized Betas

The results show that attractiveness ($\beta = 0.107$) and anthropomorphism ($\beta = 0.104$) are the strongest predictors of trust in AI influencers. Transparency ($\beta = 0.095$) and authenticity ($\beta = 0.095$) also make meaningful contributions. Psychological distance ($\beta = 0.083$) and credibility ($\beta = 0.081$) have moderate effects, while content quality ($\beta = 0.074$), expertise ($\beta = 0.072$), and homophily ($\beta = 0.064$) show relatively smaller impacts.

Table 2. Variance Inflation Factors.

Predictor	**Std. Beta**
Attractiveness	0.107
Anthropomorphism	0.104
Transparency	0.095
Authenticity	0.095
Psychological distance	0.083
Credibility	0.081
Content quality	0.074
Expertise	0.072
Homophily	0.064

3.7.3 SEM Path Coefficients

The SEM results show that all hypothesized paths were positive. Transparency (β =0.090), anthropomorphism (β = 0.083), and psychological distance (β = 0.079) had the strongest associations with trust-related evaluations. Trust was positively associated with engagement (ß = and influencer loyalty (β = 0.316). Engagement (β = 0.131) and loyalty (β = 0.128) were also positively associated with brand trust. Overall, the results support the proposed trust-based framework, but they should be interpreted as text-derived associations rather than causal effects.

Table 3. SEM Path Coefficients

Path	Predictor	B	95%CI Lower	95% CI Upper
Trust ~ attribute	const	-0.002	-0.002	-0.002
Trust ~ attribute	credibility	0.043	0.041	0.044
Trust ~ attribute	expertise	0.054	0.052	0.056
Trust ~ attribute	authenticity	0.077	0.074	0.08
Trust ~ attribute	attractiveness	0.063	0.061	0.065
Trust ~ attribute	psychological distance	0.079	0.076	0.083
Trust ~ attribute	homophily	0.052	0.05	0.055
Trust ~ attribute	anthropomorphism	0.083	0.08	0.087
Trust ~ attribute	content quality	0.043	0.041	0.044
Trust ~ attribute	transparency	0.09	0.086	0.093
Engagement ~ Trust	const	0.004	0.004	0.004
Engagement ~ Trust	trust	0.26	0.256	0.264
Loyalty ~ Trust	const	0.007	0.007	0.007
Loyalty ~ Trust	trust	0.316	0.31	0.321
BTE + Loyalty	const	0.004	0.004	0.004
BTE + Loyalty	engagement	0.131	0.129	0.134
BTE + Loyalty	loyalty	0.128	0.125	0.131

3.7.4 Variance Inflation Factors.

All VIF values are very low, ranging from 1.16 to 1.25. A common rule is that VIF values above 5 (sometimes 10) may indicate problematic multicollinearity. Since all your values are close to 1, it means the predictors (credibility, expertise, authenticity, etc.) are independent enough from each other, and there is no multicollinearity problem in your model. This confirms that each construct is measuring a unique aspect, and the SEM results are reliable.

Table 4. Variance Inflation Factors

Feature	VIF
credibility	1.18
expertise	1.187
authenticity	1.201
attractiveness	1.161
psychological distance	1.189
homophily	1.176
anthropomorphism	1.18
content quality	1.18
transparency	1.248

3.8 Regression Analysis Overview

To complement the SEM results, additional regression analyses were conducted to examine the robustness of the associations between Al influencer attributes and trust-related evaluations. OLS regression was used as the baseline model, while sentiment-weighted regression examined whether emotional tone strengthened these associations. Interaction regression was then used to test whether combinations of attributes, such as credibility and attractiveness, were jointly associated with trust.

3.8.1 Sentiment-Weighted Regression Results

The sentiment-weighted regression showed that credibility (($\beta = 0.149$, $p < 0.001$), attractiveness (($\beta = 0.103$, $p < 0.001$), and content quality ($\beta = 0.149$, $p < 0.001$) were positively associated with trust-related evaluations. Credibility and content quality showed the strongest associations, suggesting that users respond more positively when AI influencers appear reliable and provide valuable content. This finding is consistent with the Source Credibility Model, which emphasizes that trustworthy and informative sources are more persuasive (Hovland et al., 1953). However, the low R^2 indicates that emotional tone explains only a limited part of trust-related responses.

Table 5. Sentiment-Weighted Regression.

Predictor	Coef. (B)	SE	t-value	p-value	95%CI [Lower,Upper]	R^2	Adj. R^2	F-stat	Durbin-Watson	Cond No.
Constant	0.6328	0	1412.05	0	[0.632, 0.634]	0.007	0.007	961.8	1.839	20.1
Credibility (Sentiment-Weighted)	0.1512	0.004	36.254	0	[0.143, 0.159]					
Attractiveness (Sentiment-Weighted)	0.1035	0.007	15.062	0	[0.090, 0.117]					
Content Quality (Sentiment-Weighted)	0.1489	0.009	16.77	0	[0.132, 0.166]					

3.8.2 Multiple Regression Results

The multiple regression results showed that credibility ($\beta = 0.0691$, $p < 0.001$), attractiveness ($\beta = 0.0687$, $p < 0.001$), and content quality ($\beta = 0.0416$, $p < 0.001$) were all positively associated with trust. Credibility had the strongest coefficient, indicating that perceived reliability remains central in shaping trust in AI influencers. This supports prior influencer marketing research showing that credibility is a key driver of consumer trust and message effectiveness (Lou & Yuan, 2019). Nevertheless, the low R' suggests that trust in AI influencers is also influenced by other factors not included in this model.

Table 6. Multiple Regression

Predictor	Coef. (B)	SE	t-value	p-value	95% CI [Lower,Upper]	R^2	Adj. R^2	F-stat	Durbin Watson	Cond. No.
Constant	0.6323	0.00	1394.841	0	[0.631, 0.633]	0.004	0.004	636.8	1.84	11
Credibility Score	0.0798	0.003	28.796	0	[0.074, 0.085]					
Attractiveness Score	0.0887	0.005	18.667	0	[0.079, 0.098]					
Content Quality Total Score	0.0444	0.004	9.961	0	[0.036, 0.053]					

3.8.3 Interaction Regression Results

The interaction model showed that credibility strengthened the associations between attractiveness and trust ($\beta = 0.0455$, $p < 0.001$) and between content quality and trust ($\beta = 0.0490$, $p < 0.001$). This suggests that attractiveness and content quality may be more trust-relevant when the Al influencer is also perceived as credible. However, the interaction between attractiveness and content quality was negative ($\beta = -0.0865$, $p < 0.001$), suggesting that highly polished visual appeal combined with dense content may reduce perceived authenticity. This pattern is consistent with prior research showing that overly curated influencer content can weaken authenticity perceptions (Audrezet et al., 2020).

Table 7. Interaction Terms Regression

Predictor	Coef. (B)	SE	t-value	p-value	95% CI [Lower, Upper]	R^2	Adj. R^2	F-stat	Durbin-Watson	Cond. No.
Constant	0.6326	0	1391.063	0	[0.632, 0.634]	0.005	0.005	336.7	1.84	30.6
Credibility Score	0.0691	0.003	22.942	0	[0.063, 0.075]					
Attractiveness Score	0.0687	0.007	10.322	0	[0.056, 0.082]					
Content Quality Total Score	0.0416	0.005	8.009	0	[0.031, 0.052]					
Credibility × Attractiveness	0.0455	0.007	6.63	0	[0.032, 0.059]					
Credibility × Content Quality	0.049	0.008	5.817	0	[0.032, 0.066]					
Attractiveness × Content Quality	-0.0865	0.013	-6.498	0	[-0.113, -0.060]					

4 Discussion and Implications

This study found that transparency, anthropomorphism, and psychological distance were the strongest attributes associated with trust in AI influencers. This supports prior research showing that credibility, human-like cues, and social closeness are important for trust formation in digital communication (Hovland et al., 1953; Epley,2018; Trope & Liberman, 2010). Trust was also positively associated with engagement and influencer loyalty, which were further associated with brand trust, consistent with trust transfer theory (Stewart, 2003). For marketers, the findings suggest that AI influencers should be designed to appear transparent, consistent, and relatable, visually attractive. However, the low R^2 values show that consumer responses are also shaped by other factors, such as platform context, brand familiarity, campaign type, and user attitudes toward AI (Hair et al., 2019).

5 Conclusion

This study analyzed 429,193 Instagram comments to examine consumer responses to AI influencers. The findings suggest that transparency, anthropomorphism, and psychological distance are important trust-related attributes, while trust is linked to engagement, loyalty, and brand trust. These results align with prior studies. source credibility, anthropomorphism, and influencer marketing effectiveness (Hovland et al., 1953; Lou & Yuan, 2019; Epley, 2018).

However, because the study uses observational social media comments, the results should be interpreted as associations rather than causal effects. Future research should use advanced NLP methods, manual validation, multi-platform data, and longitudinal designs to better capture how trust in AI influencers develops over time.

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Appendix A. Examples of Construct Keywords Based on Prior Literature

Construct	Meaning in this study	Supporting literature	Example keywords
Credibility	Perceived reliability and believability of the AI influencer	Hovland et al. (1953); Ohanian (1990); Lou & Yuan (2019)	credible, reliable, trustworthy, believable
Expertise	Perceived knowledge or competence of the AI influencer	Hovland et al. (1953); Ohanian (1990); McGuire (1968)	expert, professional, skilled, knowledgeable
Authenticity	Perceived sincerity, genuineness, and consistency	Baker & Martinson (2002); Vannini & Franzese (2008); Molleda (2010)	authentic, real, genuine, honest

Attractiveness	Perceived appeal and positive impression of the influencer	McGuire (1968); Ohanian (1990); Sternthal & Samuel (1982)	beautiful, attractive, pretty, stylish
Psychological distance	Perceived social closeness or distance between user and influencer	Trope & Liberman (2010); Edwards et al. (2009)	close, relatable, connected, distant
Homophily	Perceived similarity between influencer and audience	De Veirman et al. (2017); Schouten et al. (2021)	similar, like me, same, shared
Anthropomorphism	Human-like qualities attributed to AI influencers	Epley et al. (2007); Epley (2018); Glikson & Woolley (2020)	human, human-like, realistic, alive
Content quality	Perceived usefulness, clarity, and value of content	Pick (2020); Wang & Qiu (2024); Lou & Yuan (2019)	useful, informative, creative, high-quality
Transparency	Disclosure and openness about AI-generated nature	Boerman et al. (2017); Evans et al. (2017); Kong et al. (2023)	transparent, disclose, AI-generated, virtual
Trust	Confidence in the AI influencer's reliability	Morgan & Hunt (1994); Mayer et al. (1995); Alboqami (2023)	trust, believe, confidence, reliable
Engagement	Active interaction or emotional involvement with content	Vivek et al. (2012); Trunfio & Rossi (2021)	like, comment, share, follow
Influencer loyalty	Continued support or attachment to the influencer	Oliver (1999); Morgan & Hunt (1994)	loyal, fan, support, always
Brand trust	Confidence in the brand associated with the influencer	Doney & Cannon (1997); Becerra & Korgaonkar (2011); Sichtmann (2007)	brand, product, company, quality